SYED HASSAN AHMED

GRC ANALYST | IT RISK & COMPLIANCE | CLOUD SECURITY

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

GRC Analyst with experience supporting security and compliance in a cloud-based business, backed by a 10-year career in regulated broadcast media. Skilled in risk assessment, control mapping, policy documentation, vendor reviews, audit evidence, and corrective-action tracking. AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner with portfolio case studies in incident response, cloud assurance, and risk management.

KEY SKILLS

Governance, risk and compliance: Risk registers, likelihood/impact scoring, treatment plans, gap assessments, control mapping, third-party risk, policy documentation, audit evidence, corrective-action tracking

Frameworks and privacy: ISO/IEC 27001:2022, ISO 31000, NIST CSF 2.0, NIST RMF, SOC 2; privacy support for GDPR and CCPA

Cloud and technical: AWS, IAM, shared responsibility, Terraform, EKS, RDS, Secrets Manager, GitHub Actions, OIDC, Python/Flask, OSCAL, OpenTelemetry

WORK EXPERIENCE

GRC Analyst (Remote) | Multi Chaos Media | Michigan, USA

March 2026 - Present

• Lead GRC activities for client information, campaign data, and cloud-hosted production workflows; maintain scored risks, treatment plans, and accountable owners.

• Assess cloud infrastructure, web applications, and delivery processes; work with technical teams to prioritize and track security remediation.

• Review customer-database access, least privilege, data classification, encryption requirements, and retention practices.

• Perform ISO/IEC 27001:2022, NIST CSF 2.0, and SOC 2 gap assessments; map overlapping controls and support client security questionnaires.

• Maintain access control, incident response, acceptable use, and data protection policies; review SaaS vendors, advertising platforms, and freelancers handling client data.

• Support privacy data mapping and processing records; coordinate evidence, internal reviews, corrective actions, leadership reporting, and security awareness guidance.

Lead News Producer | BOL Network | Karachi, Pakistan

September 2019 - Present

• Lead editorial governance and risk-based review for live and recorded broadcasts under legal and regulatory exposure.

• Develop and apply SOPs for production workflows, incident escalation, and crisis coverage; coordinate teams and brief senior leadership on emerging risks.

• Coordinate newsroom teams, management, and external stakeholders to deliver accurate, standards-compliant information under strict deadlines.

Earlier BOL roles: Program Manager (July 2017 - September 2019); Producer (December 2016 - July 2017); Associate Producer (September 2016 - November 2016).

Additional experience: Founder & Business Owner, XLO (July 2020 - March 2022); Senior Marketing Executive, Souda Ghar (January - May 2021). Supplier coordination, customer issue handling, and business operations.

CONTINUED | SYED HASSAN AHMED

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SELECTED PROJECTS

Portfolio case studies use public-source research or synthetic evidence. They are separate from employment responsibilities and do not represent client audit engagements.

Phishing Incident Response Playbook - Created an end-to-end response package and interactive walkthrough for a fictional phishing and business email compromise scenario. Includes a one-page checklist, triage/containment/recovery decision flows, severity gates, roles/RACI, UTC timeline, communications and evidence templates, and sanitized synthetic mail, identity, mailbox, endpoint, and finance records with SHA-256 manifest. Maps response work to NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 3 and selected MITRE ATT&CK techniques. Portfolio: github.com/shassanahmed93-rgb/phishing-incident-response-playbook | shassanahmed.space/projects/phishing-ir/

Third-Party Risk Assessment - Public-source Notion review for a fictional SaaS buyer: 30 questions, evidence coverage, and a critical-question approval gate. Includes reusable questionnaire, evidence requests, and proposed onboarding decision.

AWS-SOC 2 Evidence Mapping - Twelve selected criterion mappings with control procedures, shared responsibilities, and evidence requests. Includes offline/read-only collection tooling; live AWS evidence remains uncollected.

Cloud Credential Incident Tabletop - Eight authored injects on a fictional 120-minute clock, with model decisions, facilitator guide, observer templates, and an improvement plan. No actual participant response-time claim.

Cloud Controls Mock Internal Audit - Ten fixture-based workpapers linking criteria, populations, evidence, findings, and retests. Two scoped passes, five exceptions, and three inconclusive results; eight proposed corrective actions.

Cloud Assurance Lab - Connected eight risks, eight controls, and test results to five remediation findings. Built a searchable register, risk heat map, CSV export, and executive briefing using synthetic evidence.

Cloud GRC OSCAL Platform - Python/Flask dashboard for synthetic findings, illustrative risk scoring, and selected NIST SP 800-53 references. Added CSV and example OSCAL SSP exports, with pytest coverage.

Enterprise Risk Register & ISO 27001 ISMS Documentation - Fictional manufacturer case study: 75 risks across 13 categories, including 56 cyber risks; 5x5 scoring, treatment plans, KRIs, and draft 93-control Annex A mapping. Includes ISMS scope, policies, and privacy gap assessment.

Journal API on AWS - Built and deployed a FastAPI/PostgreSQL API using Terraform, EKS, private RDS, Secrets Manager, and OIDC-based CI/CD. Added OpenTelemetry observability; resources retired after deployment verification.

Cybersecurity Labs Collection - Nine reproducible labs covering phishing triage, SOC alert explanation, cloud and identity attack detection, million-event log analysis, dry-run IOC blocking, risk registration, incident planning, and evidence-based reporting. Includes comparison scenarios and exportable synthetic evidence. Portfolio: shassanahmed.space/cyber-labs/

EDUCATION

MA, Mass Communication / Media Studies | University of Karachi | 2016

BA, Mass Communication / Media Studies | University of Karachi | 2015

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (CLF-C02); Empire Certified GRC Analyst (ECGRC); CyberExam Certified GRC Practitioner; ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Implementation; ISO/IEC 27701 Lead Auditor (training course); SOC 2 Compliance and Readiness; NIST CSF 2.0; PCI DSS 4.0.1; ISC2 GRC Foundations; Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate; Cisco Junior Cybersecurity Analyst Career.